

Meen Chanda: The Fish Market Haggling Simulator

A voice-driven negotiation game that turns the tone of your own voice into gameplay

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Category	Overnight Hackathon Submission
Platform	Web application (browser-based, client-side audio processing)

Problem Statement

Haggling at a Kerala fish market is a deeply human interaction where tone matters as much as words. Yet almost every digital negotiation simulator reduces this to plain text: an input box, a typed reply, and a number that changes. None of them capture the one thing that actually drives a real haggle, which is how something is said, not just what is said. There is no existing interactive system that treats a person's live voice, its volume, pitch, and pace, as real gameplay input rather than something to be stripped away before processing.

Proposed Solution

We propose a browser-based game where the player haggles out loud with an animated Kerala fish-seller character. The Web Audio API analyses the player's live microphone input for volume and pitch, while the Web Speech API tracks speaking pace, combining all three into a single Haggle Aggression Score for every line spoken. This score drives a simple negotiation state machine: calm, measured speech nudges the fish's price down, while loud, fast, high-pitched speech pushes it up, exactly like a real stubborn seller digging in. A language model, prompted to role-play the seller's personality, generates only the spoken comeback line in character and never touches the price itself. Each round runs for a fixed number of exchanges before the final price locks in against the fish's fair value, with a stretch-goal leaderboard for titles like Loudest Loser and Calmest Customer.

Innovation and Uniqueness

Unlike most AI-character projects, where an LLM chat reply is the entire mechanic, here the actual gameplay decision comes from real-time acoustic signal processing in the browser, while the language model only supplies dialogue flavour. This shifts the technical core toward genuine audio engineering rather than prompt engineering. The second, more human layer of originality is that the "obvious" strategy is deliberately wrong: players instinctively push harder and speak louder to get a better deal, but the game inverts that, because that inversion is both the joke and the truth, since the loudest customer rarely gets the best price at any real fish market.

Prepared as a project proposal for overnight hackathon submission.